

RULES FOR PARTICIPATING in the Alpine Climate Data Challenge

1. Introduction

- 1.1. These rules and regulations ("Rules") concern the terms and conditions for taking part in an online hackathon event, with hybrid prize-giving (with on-site event and live video), called "Alpine Climate Data Challenge", which can be found at the following link
<https://journal.opendataplayground.com/alpine-climate-data-challenge-en/>
- 1.2. The Challenge is organised and managed by
 - 1.2.1. **Open Search Tech S.r.l.**, with registered office in Via G. Nicotera, 7, 00195, Rome, C.F., P.IVA and Company Register of Rome no. 15951221009 ("**OST**"), as owner of the online platform "Open Data Playground" ("**ODP**") and in cooperation with the partners listed in Appendix 1 ("**Partners**") and the sponsors listed in Appendix 2 ("**Sponsors**")
 - 1.2.2. **Tunnel Euralpin Lyon Turin SAS**, hereinafter referred to, for brevity, as "**TELT**", No. SIREN 439556952 - TVA 03439556952 - P.IVA 08332340010 -, with registered office in Chambéry (France), Bâtiment LINKLAB - 455 Chemin de la Cassine and operational office in Turin (Italy) via Nizza 40, - IT-10125 Turin (TO).
- 1.3. The Challenge includes the participation as technical partners of
 - 1.3.1. Palantir Italia [Palantir Italia s.r.l., registered office in Largo Angelo Fochetti 29, 00154, ROMA (RM), VAT and tax code 11971091001]
 - 1.3.2. Fourth Age [Fourth Age LLC, PO Box 31596, Philadelphia, PA 19147, USA, Company Number 3066824]
 - 1.3.3. SoBigData [CNR via G. Moruzzi 1 56124 Pisa, Italy, [https://pnrr.sobigdata.it/]. The SoBigData.it project aims to strengthen the Italian research infrastructure for Social Mining and Big Data analysis, promoting interdisciplinary research on social complexity with an ethical and responsible approach to data science.
- 1.4. The aim of the Organisers and of the Partners of the project, through the Challenge, is to:
 - 1.4.1. (i) firstly, to identify players with certain characteristics and skills, particularly in Data Science, interested in participating in the Challenge
 - 1.4.2. (ii) on the basis of the results of the solutions provided by the Participants ("Solutions") in response to the tests, "problems" or questions which are the subject of the Challenge ("Questions"), to award one or more Participants in the Challenge - whom the Organisers consider as "winners" on the basis of the evaluation criteria set out below - with the prizes set out below ("Prizes").
- 1.5. The addressees, stages, eligibility requirements, content of the Questions, participation modalities, selection and evaluation criteria of the Solutions and - in general - the terms and conditions of the Challenge are:
 - 1.5.1. independently determined by OST, TELT and the technical-scientific committee that will form the evaluation jury for the outputs provided.
 - 1.5.2. in the following Rules, accessible at any time in the Challenge section of the Platform.
- 1.6. By reason of the objectives and operation of the Challenge, the latter does not constitute a prize event within the meaning of Presidential Decree No. 430/2001, as it expressly falls within the exclusion clause of Article 6, para. 1(a) of the same source of legislation ("*Competitions and prize-winning operations shall not be considered to be competitions and prize-winning operations*")

where they are organised for the production of literary, artistic or scientific works, or for the presentation of projects or studies in the commercial or industrial field, in which the awarding of the prize to the author of the chosen work is in the nature of consideration for work performed or represents recognition of personal merit or encouragement in the interest of the community").

2. Aim of the Challenge

- 2.1. The Challenge invites university students and PhD students in the fields of artificial intelligence (AI), data science, environmental engineering, economics, etc. to create predictive models and visualisation tools, based on climate data, to anticipate climate impacts on the areas of the Susa and the Maurienne Valleys, between Italy and France. Participants will be provided with an advanced data analysis platforms, provided by SoBigData and Palantir, to aid them. The aim of the event is to demonstrate how technological innovation, with the use of machine learning and artificial intelligence tools, can contribute concretely to climate action and improve the sustainability of territories.
- 2.2. Develop predictive models to analyze climate impacts in the Val di Susa and Maurienne Valley territories, based on publicly available data, autonomously sourced from public databases.
- 2.3. The task aims to develop a customized climate model for the two valleys, combining historical climate data with IPCC scenarios. It is essential to simulate the evolution of key climate variables, such as temperature, precipitation, wind, humidity, atmospheric pressure, and snow cover, to estimate the future impact of climate change on these regions. The output should be made accessible through interactive tools and visual content to enhance understanding and dissemination of results.
- 2.4. The activity must include:
 - 2.4.1. I. Cleaning and normalization of climate data to ensure temporal and spatial consistency
 - 2.4.2. II. Identification of recurring patterns and seasonal changes
 - 2.4.3. III. Analysis of local topographic and climatic characteristics to calibrate the model
 - 2.4.4. IV. Integration of global and regional datasets (e.g., ERA5, Copernicus, etc.) to obtain a comprehensive and accurate picture
 - 2.4.5. V. Use of dynamic climate models (e.g., WRF, etc.) to simulate future scenarios up to 2050
 - 2.4.6. VI. Model validation through comparison with observed climate data
 - 2.4.7. VII. Development of a dashboard structure that centralizes simulated climate data, allowing an intuitive understanding of predicted scenarios
- 2.5. Expected Outputs:
 - 2.5.1. Local climate model: Detailed simulations up to 2050, focusing on seasonal changes and extreme conditions
 - 2.5.2. Interactive dashboard: Exploration of key local climate scenarios and comparison with global trends
 - 2.5.3. App prototype: An interactive and educational tool to raise awareness among schools, institutions, and local communities about the potential impacts of climate change
 - 2.5.4. Advanced UI/UX components: Intuitive layouts, thematic maps, and narrative content to make the regional climate change impact more comprehensible, providing an intuitive user experience suitable for both experts and the general public
- 2.6. The Final Solution must be uploaded to the team-dedicated folder in the Palantir platform provided by ODP.
- 2.7. The Challenge will be held from 09:00: 00 AM (CET) on 22/02/25 to 09:00:00 AM (CET) on 03/03/25.

- 2.8. The Challenge is a qualitative competition. The Solution proposed by the teams will have to be evaluated by the event Juries.
- 2.9. Composition of the Juries:
 - 2.9.1. Scientific Committee composed by UNITO, USMB, TELT environment, Geology and ICT Divisions Palantir, Fourth Age, Machine Learning Reply, Lutech and presidents Emanuela Girardi of POPAI and Lionel Gros of TELT.
 - 2.9.2. Institutional Jury composed by members of CERN, ITER, SGP, LINKS, CDI Collège des Ingénieurs, Développement Durable Savoie, TECNE Autostrade, Associazione CCI ALPMED, by the captain Aldo Razzino of Open Data Playground and by two presidents Manuela Rocca of TELT and Andrea Giuliacci of Meteo Giuliacci.
 - 2.9.3. The Scientific Committee is convened online between the end of the hackathon and 7 March 2025 to evaluate the innovative ideas, according to an evaluation grid prepared by the ODP. The Scientific Committee is called upon to draw the five best innovations.
- 2.10. The five teams that will be identified as finalists by the event's Scientific Committee will be invited to participate in the final event, which will take place on 12/03/2025 from 9:30 AM to 12:30 PM, in hybrid mode. In person at the TELT headquarters in via Nizza, 40 in Turin and online in video conference. At this event, TELT guarantees all participants a final networking lunch only. Any travel and accommodation will be paid for by the participants.
- 2.11. During the final event, the top five finalist teams will be invited to present the results of their analysis in a Pitch Presentation lasting up to 15-20 minutes per group.
- 2.12. Following the presentations of the finalist teams, on 12/03/2025 the Institutional Jury of the event will decide, according to an evaluation grid prepared by ODP, the final ranking and, therefore, the winners.
- 2.13. Teams will be able to consult on the Platform or in the manner indicated by the organisers, the uploaded documents relating to:
 - 2.13.1. (i) the manner in which the Challenge is conducted
 - 2.13.2. (ii) how to upload Solutions (both interim and final)

3. Candidates and requirements for participation

- 3.1. The organized Challenge is publicly open to any university and PhD student enrolled at a university.
- 3.2. Students who have completed their studies within one year prior to the start of the hackathon (from February 22, 2024 onward) are also eligible to participate.
- 3.3. Participation in the Challenge is open to natural persons “**Players**”) who jointly meet the following requirements
 - 3.3.1. (i) be a real person
 - 3.3.2. (ii) be at least 18 years old
 - 3.3.3. (iii) be available to do the work
 - 3.3.4. (iv) have completed the event registration process and are operating as “Users”, using their personal profile (“**Profile**”)
 - 3.3.5. (v) Teams must consist of a minimum of 2 and a maximum of 4 members (“**Teams**”).
 - 3.3.6. (vi) The solution delivered on the platform must be in English.
 - 3.3.7. (vii) The model are to be developed via SoBigData
 - 3.3.8. (viii) Final data visualization solutions are to be developed via Palantir.
- 3.4. In order to participate in the Challenge, teams must upload the information and documents requested by the Sponsor itself into the appropriate folder in the Palantir Space, specifically
 - 3.4.1. Participation Data

- 3.4.1.1. (i) Google Form with Rules and Privacy Policy to be completed by 11:59:59 PM (CET) on 2019/02/23
- 3.4.1.2. (ii) Curriculum Vitae, uploaded to the designated CV folder within the Team folder on Foundry by 11:59:59 PM (CET) on 2019/02/23
- 3.5. The Participation Data must be in the team folder by 09:00:00 AM (CET) on 23/02/25.
- 3.6. If even a single team member has not uploaded their curriculum vitae and has not accepted the Privacy Policy and the Rules, the entire team will not be granted access to the hackathon folder until all members have completed the participation process and are fully compliant with the required conditions.
- 3.7. The profiles of the Players applying to participate in the Challenge will be evaluated by the Sponsors and Organisers independently and at their own discretion, and the Sponsors therefore reserve the right to award the final prizes to the Teams at their own discretion.

4. How to register and participate in the Challenge

- 4.1. Participation in the Challenge is free of charge.
- 4.2. Each team may submit its application for participating in the Challenge by 11:59:59 PM (CET) on 20/02/25, via the special page on Ticket Tailor <https://buytickets.at/opendataplayground/1332828> dedicated to the Challenge.
- 4.3. In order to submit their participation application to the Platform, each Team Player is required to complete the following registration procedure ("**Registration**"):
- 4.3.1. authenticate their Profile on Ticket Tailor;
- 4.3.2. enter Participation Data in the Registration form and, in general, the required information, in particular:
 - 4.3.2.1. First name
 - 4.3.2.2. Surname
 - 4.3.2.3. Email
 - 4.3.2.4. LinkedIn profile
 - 4.3.2.5. University of affiliation
 - 4.3.2.6. Type of degree programme (Bachelor's or Master's)
 - 4.3.2.7. Team name
 - 4.3.2.8. Indicate whether you are the team leader (Yes/No)
- 4.3.3. By using the point and click technique (i.e. by placing flags on non-preselected boxes or on interactive buttons - "**Point and Click**")
 - 4.3.3.1. Sign these Rules to accept them; expressly accept the following articles of the Rules, pursuant to and for the purposes of Articles 1341 and 1342 of the Italian Civil Code or Articles 33 and 34 of the Italian Consumer Code, depending on whether the Participant is acting as a "professional" or "consumer" within the meaning of Article 3 of Legislative Decree No. 206/2005: 5.9 (Refusal of Prize), 5.13 (Non-Awarding of Prize), 6.2.7 (Limitation of Liability), 7 (Cancellation, Suspension and Indemnification), 8.4 (Place of Jurisdiction).
 - 4.3.3.2. Accept the privacy policy pursuant to Articles 13 and 14 of EU Regulation 2016/679 (GDPR), drafted by the Promoter as an autonomous data controller within the meaning of Article 24 of the GDPR and relating to personal data - as defined in Article 4 of the GDPR ("Personal Data") - processed by the Promoter for the purposes of the Competition ("Competition Privacy Policy").

- 4.3.3.3. consent to the processing of personal data for purposes not necessary for participating in the Competition and not covered by the Competition Privacy Policy.
- 4.3.3.4. Furthermore, participants must accept the privacy policies of the partners offering job opportunities. These policies will be presented at the beginning of the hackathon through a Google Form, which must be completed in order to be eligible for any job-related opportunities provided by the partners.
- 4.3.4. As of 01/02/2025 registered participants will receive instructions by email on how they can access the training environment on Palantir and take the training courses made available to them on using the platform.
- 4.3.5. At the time the Challenge goes live, starting at 09:00: 00 AM (CET) on 22/02/25, the Teams will be able to view, access and possibly download in the folder of the ODP Foundry Platform, the Challenge material prepared by the Sponsor itself including, *inter alia*
 - 4.3.5.1. will gain access to their SoBigData folder, which will be used to develop the model.
 - 4.3.5.2. the Question;
 - 4.3.5.3. guidance on where to download open data on which to perform analyses;
 - 4.3.5.4. descriptive text of the evaluation rules for Solutions;
- 4.3.6. To be eligible to participate in the Challenge, Teams must upload the Solution to the Questions to their Dedicated folder on ODP Foundry by 09.00.00 AM on 03/03/25 ("**Final Deadline**"). Teams acknowledge that up to the Final Deadline, they may also upload "provisional" Solutions to the Platform, it being understood that the most recent Solution delivered to the Platform will be the only version of the Solution that will be evaluated by the Jury for the purposes of eventual access to the Final and recognition of the Prize.

5. Procedure for evaluating Solutions, selecting Winners and awarding Prizes

- 5.1. The Teams acknowledge and accept that - following the Final Deadline - the organisers, independently and possibly with the support of the Partners, will evaluate the Solutions submitted by the Teams and - at their discretion - will draw up a temporary ranking list to identify the Teams that will be invited to participate in the Final on 12/03/25.
- 5.2. Teams that are invited to the final but do not participate for reasons independent of the event organisers will be eliminated from the final ranking.
- 5.3. The winning teams of the Challenge Final ("**Winners**") and to whom the Prizes referred to in Article 5.7 below will be awarded, acknowledge the following key (but not exclusive) criteria:
 - 5.3.1. the greater or lesser adherence of the Solutions to the Task;
 - 5.3.2. the completeness and correctness of the documentation uploaded by the Team onto the Platform and constituting the Solution.
- 5.4. The Teams acknowledge and accept that - following the presentations during the Final on 12/03/25 - the organisers, independently and possibly with the support of the Partners, will evaluate the Presentations and Solutions submitted by the Teams and - at their discretion - draw up a final ranking list to identify the Winning Teams.
- 5.5. At the outcome of this evaluation, the organisers will publish on the Challenge's landing page <https://journal.opendataplayground.com/alpine-climate-data-challenge-en/> the final ranking of the teams participating in the Challenge in which the Winners ("**Ranking**") will be indicated by 11:59 PM on 12/03/25.
- 5.6. The Organisers undertake to award the following Prizes to the finalists:
 - 5.6.1. Four Palantir Foundry certifications for each member of the Winning Team (individual value of €250, for a total of €1,000 per each member of the first team)..
 - 5.6.2. 1 zeroCO2 tree for each member of the top three teams in the final ranking.

- 5.6.3.** CV Review service offered by Open Search Network and CDI, for all participants.
- 5.6.4.** Internships at TELT and its international partners - See Appendix 4 Partner Job Opportunities. Prizes will be awarded in order of ranking, according to the willingness of the contestants and the evaluation of the CVs by the job opportunity providers.
- 5.7.** The organisers also undertake to personally notify the Winners - by email - of the successful awarding of the Challenge, providing the Winners with further information and/or instructions on how to collect the Prize itself, no later than 60 days after the publication of the Ranking. In the event of rejection of the Prize expressed in writing by the Winner, by communication to the Sponsor by email, the Prize will be awarded to the Team ranked immediately after the Winner.
- 5.8.** The Winners acknowledge that, for the distribution of the Prizes, the Organisers may, at their discretion, make use of third-party Partners, and therefore potentially accept that they may only receive the Prizes through these third-party Partners.
- 5.9.** The Winners acknowledge that the Organisers, for the distribution of the Prizes, must await receipt of the same from suppliers and Sponsors, and therefore accept that they may only receive the Prizes when these have been provided to the Organisers.
- 5.10.** The Prize is to be considered indivisible, therefore, in the event that the Winner is a Team, the individual Players of the Team may not make individual claims in relation to the Prize.
- 5.11.** The Team acknowledges and accepts that the Sponsor, at any time and at its own discretion, may:
 - 5.11.1.** (i) not award the Prize if it considers that no Solution is suitable or appropriate in relation to the evaluation criteria
 - 5.11.2.** (ii) not to award the Prize if there is only one Team and only one Solution proposed. In such cases, by accepting these Rules, the Team expressly waives - as of now - any and all disputes and/or claims against the Sponsor, OST and/or the Partners.

6. Rules of Conduct for Teams

- 6.1.** The Challenge pursues the aims and objectives described in the previous Articles 1.1 and 2.2, each Player of each Team is therefore obliged to respect the Challenge mission by avoiding misconduct and/or behaviours aimed at hindering any other Player and/or Team or impeding the regular course of The Challenge and hindering its success.
- 6.2.** The Teams, by accepting these Rules, also possibly on behalf of other Team members pursuant to Article 1381 of the Italian Civil Code, undertake in particular to:
 - 6.2.1.** act in accordance with these Rules;
 - 6.2.2.** enter correct, complete and truthful Participation Data;
 - 6.2.3.** not use inappropriate, discriminatory and/or defamatory expressions towards other Players and/or Teams;
 - 6.2.4.** not publish content that is offensive, violent, defamatory or in any way unlawful, or that has advertising/political/ideological or religious content;
 - 6.2.5.** not upload Solutions contrary to or unrelated to the objectives and subject matter of the Challenge;
 - 6.2.6.** in every case, to not engage in any conduct that may, even potentially: (i) prejudice the successful outcome of the Challenge and/or the operation of the Platform; (ii) violate applicable law, the rights of third parties (including, but not limited to, any intellectual or industrial property rights) and/or the commercial reputation of the Sponsor, OST and Partners;
 - 6.2.7.** in every case, each Team shall be exclusively responsible for the content of the Solution uploaded to the Platform, therefore any liability on the part of OST as owner of the Platform

for any claims for damages and/or compensation made by third parties in relation to the conduct of the Players and the content published by them within the Platform is excluded.

7. Cancellation, suspension and indemnity

- 7.1.** The Organisers and the Sponsors reserve the right to cancel, modify or suspend - in whole or in part and at any time - the Challenge, at their sole discretion, subject to notification of the changes on the Platform and by email.
- 7.2.** The Organisers and Sponsors also reserve the right, at their sole discretion and at any time, to disallow or subsequently disqualify and exclude a Team from participating, in the event of actual or suspected:
 - 7.2.1.** (a) failure to meet requirements;
 - 7.2.2.** (b) non-fulfilment of the commitments referred to in Article 6.2 above.
 - 7.2.3.** Without prejudice to any further remedy, the Team undertakes to indemnify and hold harmless the Sponsors, the Organisers and the Partners from any damage, prejudice, loss, cost, expense (including legal expenses) or sanction in which they may incur as a result of a claim or action by a third party based on the Team's breach of any of the conditions of these Rules due to their negligent or wilful conduct.

8. Miscellany

- 8.1.** (*Amendments*) These Rules may be amended at any time, prior to the start of the competition scheduled for 00:00: 00 AM (CET) on 14/02/25, by the Organisers and notice of such amendment will be given publicly on the Platform and by email. In the event of a conflict between an earlier version of the Rules and subsequent amendments, the latter shall prevail.
- 8.2.** (*Severability*) If one or more of the provisions, or portions thereof, of the Rules are by applicable law or court order declared invalid, illegal or otherwise unenforceable, in whole or in part, the remaining provisions, or portions thereof, shall nevertheless remain binding and enforceable.
- 8.3.** (*Tolerance*) Any tolerance of conduct in breach of the provisions contained in the Rules does not constitute a waiver of the rights arising from the breached provisions, nor of the right to demand the exact fulfilment of all the terms and conditions set forth herein.
- 8.4.** (Applicable law and competent court) These Rules shall be governed exclusively by Italian law. Any dispute concerning these General Terms and Conditions, including their execution, interpretation and/or termination for any reason whatsoever, shall be subject to the exclusive jurisdiction of the Court of Turin, any other court having jurisdiction being excluded.

9. Appendices:

- Appendix 1: Partners
- Appendix 2: Scientific Committee
- Appendix 3: Institutional Jury
- Appendix 4: Job Opportunities Partners

Appendix 1 - Partners

Partners	Role	Website
PALANTIR	Specialist Technical Partner	https://www.palantir.com/
FOURTH AGE	Specialist Technical Partner	https://www.fourthage.com/
ZEROCO2	ESG Technical Partner	https://app.zeroco2.eco/en
OPEN SEARCH NETWORK	Specialist Technical Partner	https://www.opensearchnetwork.com/
SOBIGDATA	Specialist Technical Partner	http://www.sobigdata.eu/
AWORLD	ESG Technical Partner	https://aworld.org/
Data Science Lab, CINI	Specialist Technical Partner	https://www.consortio-cini.it/index.php/it/lab-data-science

Appendix 2 – Scientific Committee

Organization	Contact	Role
POPAI	Emanuela Girardi	President
TELT DGA FRANCE	Lionel Gros	President
UNITO	Paolo De Bernardi	Member
USMB	Philippe Bolon	Member
ENVIRONMENT DEPARTMENT TELT	Valerie Coissard	Member
ENVIRONMENT DEPARTMENT TELT	Pia Grieco	Member
ICT DEPARTMENT TELT	Domenico Paletto	Member
GEOLOGY DEPARTMENT TELT	Maria Elena Parisi	Member
Palantir	Francesca Ferretti	Member
Machine Learning Reply	Giorgia Gortuna	Member
Lutech	Claudio Perroni	Member
Fourth Age	Zach Romanow	Member

Appendix 3 – Institutional Jury

Organization	Contact	Role
TELT DGA ITALY	Manuela Rocca	President
METEOGIULIACCI	Andrea Giuliacci	President
OPEN DATA PLAYGROUND	Aldo Razzino	Captain
CERN	Luisa Ulrici	Member (online)
ITER	Orlandi Sergio	Member (online)
LINKS	Alfredo Favenza	Member
LINKS	Stefano Buscaglia	Member
CDI	Erika Vaniglia	Member
SGP	Thomas Gaudron	Member
DEVELOPPEMENT DURABLE SAVOIE	Marine Coquand	Member
CCI ALPMED ASSOCIATION	Dario Gallina	Member
TECNE - AUTOSTRADE	Nicola Nosari	Member

Appendix 4 – Job Opportunities Partners

Organization	Prizes	Website
TELT	Internship	TELT Lyon Turin • TELT Prima pagina
ITER	Internship	ITER - the way to new energy
CERN	One-day visit to the company + presentation of winning project	https://home.cern/
SGP	One-day visit to the company	Société des grands projets, accélérateur des mobilités Société des grands projets
CDI	Dedicated link to apply in their MBA master + CV Review Service + invitation to their masterclass events	MBA FELLOWSHIP PROGRAM - Italian admission Offerte di lavoro a CDI - Italia
LINKS	Internship	Fondazione LINKS - soluzioni tecnologiche dal laboratorio al mercato
POPAI	Internship at ADRA	Adra Association
PALANTIR	Palantir Foundry Certification	palantir.com
OPEN SEARCH NETWORK	CV Review Service	https://www.opensearchnetwork.com/
ZEROCO2	Tree	Progetti sostenibili e ambientali per aziende & privati zeroCO2
TECNE - AUTOSTRADE	Internship	Tecne - Autostrade per l'Italia
BCG X	Entry level	https://www.bcg.com/italy
Fourth Age	Summer Internship & Entry Level	https://www.fourthage.com/
Lutech	Entry Level	https://lutech.group/it
Machine Learning Reply	Entry Level	https://www.reply.com/machine-learning-reply/it
Moviri	Entry Level	https://www.moviri.com/
Match Guru	Entry Level	https://www.matchguru.it/
Open Data Playground	Entry Level	http://www.opendataplayground.com

WeHunt	Entry Level	https://www.wehunt.eu/
Dott.Gallina	Entry Level	https://gallina.it/
Visium	Entry Level	https://www.visium.ch/
Palantir	Review of CVs for Entry Level & Graduate Program	https://www.palantir.com/
Open Search Network	Entry Level	https://opensearchnetwork.com/
Frontiere	Entry Level	https://frontiere.io/
Innovation Center - Intesa San Paolo	Company visit and training session	https://www.intesasanpaoloinnovationscenter.com/it/